

CONTEXT FOR ASTRA

You are my German tutor. I am Kevin, Italian, level A2-B1. My lessons are taught in English by a native German speaker (Stefanie). Today we are reviewing: **Problem situations and solutions**

Sections covered: 8. Juli

LESSON SUMMARY

Kevin practiced describing problem situations and proposing solutions using conditional structures (würde + infinitive). The lesson focused on real-world scenarios: a man lost without a phone seeking directions, and a boy who broke a window with a football. Key grammar included conditional mood, reflexive verbs (sich Sorgen machen), separable verb-like structures (kaputt machen), prepositions (durch + accusative, um + accusative), and dative pronouns. Vocabulary covered borrowing/lending (leihen/ausleihen), asking for directions (um den Weg fragen), and possessive structures. Kevin demonstrated strong sentence construction with natural use of einfach and conjunctions, though still working on preposition + pronoun contractions (darüber vs. über es).

KEY VOCABULARY

- **der Strand** — beach [A2]
- **die Karte** — map [A2]
- **das Handy** — mobile phone [A2]
- **die Lösung** — solution [A2]
- **die Polizei** — police [A2]
- **die Straße** — street [A1]
- **der Weg** — way, path [A2]
- **verloren** — lost [A2]
- **das Ladekabel** — charging cable [B1]
- **leihen** — to lend, to borrow [A2]
- **ausleihen** — to borrow (to take) [B1]
- **der Bleistift** — pencil [A2]
- **der Kugelschreiber** — ballpoint pen [A2]
- **der Stift** — pen (general) [A2]
- **der Junge** — boy [A1]
- **die Sorge** — concern, worry [B1]
- **das Fenster** — window [A1]
- **kaputt** — broken [A2]
- **der Fußball** — football, soccer ball [A1]
- **werfen** — to throw [B1]
- **der Besitzer** — owner (male) [B1]
- **die Besitzerin** — owner (female) [B1]
- **das Elternhaus** — parents' house [B1]

- **die Eltern** — parents [A1]
- **durch** — through [A2]
- **einfach** — simply [A2]
- **der Wahnsinn** — madness, insanity [B1]
- **natürlich** — naturally, of course [A2]
- **sicher** — surely, certainly [A2]
- **klar** — clear, of course [A2]
- **gern** — gladly, with pleasure [A2]

GRAMMAR POINTS

Conditional mood with würde + infinitive

→ To express conditional actions (would do), German uses würde + infinitive construction. This is called Konjunktiv II with würde-form. The construction is: subject + würde (conjugated) + other elements + infinitive (at end of clause). This form is used to avoid confusion when Konjunktiv II forms are identical to Präteritum, especially for regular verbs. It's more natural than using archaic Konjunktiv II forms for many verbs.

e.g. Ich würde dir gerne helfen. (I would like to help you.)

e.g. Was würdest du in dieser Situation machen? (What would you do in this situation?)

Reflexive verb: sich Sorgen machen

→ To express worry or concern, German uses the fixed expression 'sich Sorgen machen' (literally: to make oneself worries). The noun 'Sorgen' is ALWAYS plural in this construction. Structure: subject + reflexive pronoun (dative: mir/dir/sich/uns/euch/sich) + Sorgen machen. While 'sich sorgen (um)' exists, 'sich Sorgen machen' is far more common and natural in everyday German.

e.g. Ich mache mir große Sorgen um Torsten. (I'm deeply worried about Torsten.)

e.g. Der Junge macht sich Sorgen. (The boy is worried.)

kaputt machen (separable-like structure)

→ To express breaking or destroying something, German uses 'kaputt machen' (make broken/destroy). It behaves like a separable verb: 'kaputt' separates and goes to the end in main clauses with simple tenses, but stays together in compound tenses (Perfekt/Plusquamperfekt) and in subordinate clauses. In Perfekt, it forms 'kaputt gemacht' (past participle).

e.g. Er macht das Fenster kaputt. (He breaks the window.)

e.g. Er hat ein Fenster kaputt gemacht. (He broke a window.)

Preposition durch + accusative

→ The preposition 'durch' (through, by means of) ALWAYS takes the accusative case, without exception. It expresses movement through something or means/instrument by which something happens. Common usage: durch + das/den/die (accusative articles). The preposition never changes case based on movement vs. location (unlike two-way prepositions).

e.g. Er hat den Ball durch das Fenster geworfen. (He threw the ball through the window.)

e.g. Wir fahren durch die Stadt. (We drive through the city.)

um + accusative for asking/requesting

→ The preposition 'um' with accusative case is used with verbs of asking/requesting to express asking FOR something: 'bitten um' (to ask for, request), 'fragen um' (to ask for - though 'fragen nach' is more common for inquiring about). Structure: jemanden um etwas bitten/fragen (to ask someone for something). Very common expressions: 'um Hilfe bitten' (ask for help), 'um Erlaubnis fragen' (ask for permission). Note: 'fragen nach' means 'to inquire about' while 'fragen um' means 'to ask for/request'.

e.g. *Ich bitte dich um einen Gefallen. (I'm asking you for a favor.)*

e.g. *Er bittet um Hilfe. (He asks for help.)*

USEFUL PHRASES / REDEMittel

- **Ich habe keine Ahnung** — I have no idea (*Fixed expression for complete lack of knowledge*)
- **Ja sicher** — Yes, certainly (*Natural way to say 'of course' in agreement*)
- **Ja klar** — Yes, of course (*Very common informal agreement*)
- **Er ist verloren** — He is lost (*Describing someone who cannot find their way*)
- **Das ist ein Wahnsinn** — That's crazy/amazing (*Expressing amazement (positive connotation)*)

EXERCISES TO GENERATE

1. FILL IN THE BLANK (5 sentences)

Use the key vocabulary above. Leave one word blank per sentence. Show the answer after a separator.

2. TRANSLATION DE → EN (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

3. TRANSLATION EN → DE (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

4. DIALOGUE COMPLETION (2 short dialogues, 3-4 lines)

Leave one or two lines blank. Context: everyday situations using today's grammar (Conditional mood with *würde* + infinitive).

5. FREE WRITING PROMPT

Ask me to write 3-5 sentences in German using at least 5 words from today's vocabulary.

6. GRAMMAR DRILL (5 sentences)

Focus on: Conditional mood with *würde* + infinitive. Show sentences with errors for me to correct.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Correct all my answers immediately with explanation in English
- Note recurring mistakes throughout the session
- Use only A2-B1 vocabulary unless I ask for more
- If I write something correct but unnatural, suggest a more native alternative
- Use 'die KI' not 'AI' when referring to artificial intelligence